

Connecting keja.app

A step-by-step walkthrough for pointing the `keja.app` domain at the Netlify production deployment — adding the custom domain, configuring DNS, issuing the HTTPS certificate, and verifying that everything resolves correctly worldwide.

DEPLOYED SITE

keja-ai.netlify.app

CANONICAL URL

https://keja.app

PLATFORM

Netlify CDN

SECTION 01

Overview — What This Guide Does

The Keja AI application is built as a static export from the Next.js 16 codebase and served from Netlify's global CDN. Today it is reachable at the auto-assigned subdomain `keja-ai.netlify.app`. This guide walks through the process of attaching the custom domain `keja.app` so that visitors reach the exact same deployment at a clean, branded web address instead.

Domain linking involves three parties working together: your **registrar** (the company where `keja.app` was purchased — for example Namecheap, GoDaddy, or Squarespace), the **DNS system** (the internet's address book that translates `keja.app` into server addresses), and **Netlify** (which hosts the site and terminates HTTPS). The work splits into four steps: registering the domain inside the Netlify dashboard, pointing DNS at Netlify, issuing the TLS certificate, and setting the primary domain with the right redirects. None of these steps touch the application code — the build pipeline already treats `https://keja.app` as the canonical URL, so no code changes are needed at any point.

How a visitor reaches the site after configuration:

1 · Browser

User types `keja.app`

2 · DNS lookup

Domain resolves to Netlify's load balancer

3 · Netlify edge

CDN matches the domain to your site

4 · Keja AI

App served over HTTPS

GOOD TO KNOW

You have two ways to connect DNS: handing DNS management entirely to Netlify (recommended, simplest long-term), or keeping DNS at your registrar and pointing specific records at Netlify. Section 4 covers both paths — pick exactly one.

SECTION 02

Before You Start

Completing this checklist first avoids the most common causes of stalled domain setups. Each item below should be verifiable in a couple of minutes, and every one

of them has stopped a real deployment at some point, so it is worth being honest about each before touching any DNS settings.

- ☐ **The site is deployed and live.** Open `https://keja-ai.netlify.app` in a browser and confirm the Keja AI app loads. The deploy pipeline runs from GitHub Actions on every push to `main`, using the `NETLIFY_AUTH_TOKEN` and `NETLIFY_SITE_ID` repository secrets. If the subdomain does not load, fix the deployment first — domain linking cannot help an unpublished site.
- ☐ **You can sign in to Netlify** as the owner (or a collaborator with domain permissions) of the site. Custom-domain settings require this access level.
- ☐ **You can sign in to the registrar that holds `keja.app`** and can edit its DNS zone — either changing nameservers or adding A / CNAME records. If someone else manages the domain, arrange access or hand them Section 4 of this guide.
- ☐ **You know whether `keja.app` currently has live email** (MX records for Google Workspace, Zoho, etc.). If it does, note the existing records before switching DNS — see the warning in Path A below.
- ☐ **You have up to 24–48 hours of patience.** DNS changes usually propagate in minutes but can take longer depending on TTL caching. Plan the switch for a low-traffic window so nobody depends on immediate availability.

SECTION 03

Step 1 — Add the Domain in Netlify

The domain must be registered on the Netlify side first, so Netlify knows to serve traffic that arrives asking for `keja.app`. Until this is done, even perfectly correct DNS records will land on a Netlify error page, because the edge network has no site bound to that hostname.

1 Open domain management

In the Netlify dashboard, select the Keja AI site, then open **Site configuration → Domain management → Domains**.

```
app.netlify.com → keja-ai → Site configuration → Domain management
```

2 Add the primary hostname

Click **Add a domain**, choose **Custom domain**, and enter `keja.app` (the apex domain, without `www` and without `https://`). Netlify will check the domain and add it to the site. If Netlify warns that the domain is owned by another Netlify account or team, resolve that ownership claim first — it usually means an old site in another account still holds the hostname.

3 Add the www variant

Repeat the same flow and add `www.keja.app` as a second custom domain. Both hostnames should now appear in the domain list with a status of **"Checking DNS"** or similar — that is expected, because DNS has not been pointed yet. Netlify will display its recommended DNS configuration right on this page; Section 4 puts it into practice.

SECTION 04

Step 2 — Configure DNS (Two Paths)

This is the only part of the process that happens outside Netlify, at your registrar. There are two mutually exclusive ways to do it. Path A delegates the whole DNS zone to Netlify, which then manages every record for you automatically — including certificate validation and future records. Path B keeps DNS at the registrar and only points the two records Netlify needs. Both end at the same place; the difference is where the DNS zone lives afterward.

Path A — Netlify DNS

RECOMMENDED

With this approach you tell the registrar "Netlify is now in charge of this domain's DNS", by replacing the registrar's default nameservers with the four Netlify-assigned ones. Netlify then automatically creates the apex A record, the `www` CNAME, and all certificate-validation records, and keeps them correct forever — even if Netlify's underlying IP addresses change in the future.

A1 Get your assigned nameservers

In Netlify: **Site configuration** → **Domain management** → **Domains** → **keja.app** → **Options** → **Set up Netlify DNS**. Follow the wizard. Netlify will display four nameservers that look like:

```
# example — use exactly the four Netlify shows you
dns1.p06.nsone.net
dns2.p06.nsone.net
dns3.p06.nsone.net
dns4.p06.nsone.net
```

A2 Replace the nameservers at the registrar

In your registrar's dashboard, find the **nameserver (DNS) settings** for **keja.app** and replace the existing entries with the four Netlify nameservers, exactly as spelled, including any trailing dots if the registrar shows them. Save the change. Nameserver delegation is the slowest DNS operation to propagate — allow anywhere from a few minutes up to 24 hours (rarely 48).

A3 Re-create any custom records

Once the zone moves to Netlify, only the records Netlify creates exist. If you had email or other services on this domain, re-create their records under **Netlify** → **Domains** → **keja.app** → **DNS records** (for example MX records for Google Workspace, a TXT record for SPF, and DKIM CNAMEs).

IMPORTANT — EMAIL

If **keja.app** currently receives email, switching nameservers without copying the MX/SPF/DKIM records will **stop mail delivery**. Note down every existing DNS record before changing nameservers, or choose Path B instead.

Path B — Keep DNS at Your Registrar

ALTERNATIVE

With this approach the registrar keeps managing the zone, and you point two records at Netlify by hand. It is the right choice when the domain shares DNS with other services (email, subdomains used elsewhere) that you do not want to

migrate. The trade-off: if Netlify's apex IP ever changes, the A record must be updated manually.

In your registrar's DNS editor for `keja.app`, create or edit these records:

Type	Name / Host	Value / Target	TTL
A	@ (apex)	75.2.60.5	3600 or default
CNAME	www	keja-ai.netlify.app	3600 or default

Registrar editors differ in small ways: some use `@` for the apex and others want the full domain `keja.app.` ; some add the domain to the CNAME target automatically and some do not. If the editor rejects a CNAME at `www` , check for a conflicting pre-existing record (an A record or a redirect rule on `www`) and delete it first.

WHY ONLY THESE TWO RECORDS

The apex domain cannot be a CNAME (DNS does not allow it), so it points at Netlify's load-balancer IP `75.2.60.5`. The `www` subdomain can be an alias, so it points at your site's Netlify subdomain. Do not add records for other subdomains — everything else about the site is served by Netlify once these two resolve.

SECTION 05

Step 3 — HTTPS & SSL Certificate

Netlify issues free TLS certificates through Let's Encrypt for every custom domain, so `keja.app` gets full HTTPS with no purchases and no manual certificate work. The only requirement is that DNS must first point at Netlify — the certificate is provisioned only after Netlify can prove it controls the hostname, which happens automatically once the records from Section 4 resolve.

1 Wait for DNS check

In **Domain management** → **Domains**, watch the status next to `keja.app` move from "Checking DNS" to "Netlify DNS" or a green check. For Path A this happens once the nameserver delegation propagates; for Path B once the A and CNAME records resolve.

2 Provision the certificate

Open **Domain management** → **HTTPS** for `keja.app`. If the certificate does not provision by itself within an hour of DNS resolving, click **Verify DNS certificate** to trigger the attempt manually. Provisioning takes a minute or two; the status should end at "Cert issued" or similar.

3 Force HTTPS for everyone

On the same HTTPS panel, enable **Force HTTPS** for both `keja.app` and `www.keja.app`. Every plain-HTTP request will then be redirected (301) to the secure version. Do this only after the certificate shows as issued, otherwise visitors would hit certificate errors.

RENEWALS ARE AUTOMATIC

Let's Encrypt certificates last 90 days and Netlify renews them automatically behind the scenes — you will never receive an expiry warning for `keja.app` and there is nothing to schedule. If a renewal ever fails, the HTTPS panel shows a "Last renewal" warning; clicking Verify DNS certificate usually fixes it.

SECTION 06

Step 4 — Primary Domain & Redirects

With both hostnames attached and secured, decide which one is the single official address. Keja AI is built around the apex domain — the application's `SITE_URL` constant already defaults to `https://keja.app` and the sitemap, robots.txt, canonical tags and PWA manifest all derive from it — so `keja.app` must be the primary domain and everything else must redirect to it. This keeps a single URL in search results and analytics.

1 Set `keja.app` as primary

In **Domain management** → **Domains**, find `keja.app`, open its **Options** menu and choose **Set as primary domain**. The label "Primary domain" should now sit next to `keja.app`, with `www.keja.app` listed as a secondary alias.

2 Confirm automatic redirects

Once HTTPS certificates exist for all three hostnames, Netlify automatically 301-redirects `www.keja.app` and `keja-ai.netlify.app` to `https://keja.app`. Test both after setup (Section 7 shows the exact commands). If a redirect does not appear, it is almost always because the certificate for that hostname is not issued yet — finish Section 5 for it first.

ONE PRIMARY ONLY

Never leave `keja.app` and `www.keja.app` serving content in parallel without a redirect — search engines treat them as duplicate sites and split ranking signals between them. The primary-domain setting plus automatic redirects prevents this; just verify it with the curl test in the next section.

SECTION 07

Verify Everything Works

Give DNS a little time to spread, then confirm each layer independently: the DNS records, the redirect chain, and the certificate. All commands below work on macOS and Linux terminals; Windows users can run them in WSL or use the web checkers mentioned at the end. Each command tests one specific thing, so a failure tells you exactly which layer to fix.

1 Check the apex A record

Run these from any terminal (macOS, Linux, or WSL):

```
dig keja.app A +short  
# expected: 75.2.60.5
```


2 Check the www CNAME

www must be an alias for the Netlify subdomain:

```
dig www.keja.app CNAME +short  
# expected: keja-ai.netlify.app.
```

3 Check the redirect chain and certificate

Both requests must return a 301 pointing at the apex:

```
curl -sI http://keja.app | head -n 1  
curl -sI https://www.keja.app | head -n 1  
# expected for both:  
# HTTP/2 301  
# location: https://keja.app/
```

Then open `https://keja.app` in a browser: the padlock should be present, and clicking it should show a valid certificate issued by Let's Encrypt to `keja.app`.

PROPAGATION CHECKERS

DNS answers are cached differently around the world. Enter `keja.app` at `whatsmydns.net` to watch the A record propagate country by country — most locations should show `75.2.60.5` within an hour for Path B, while Path A nameserver changes may take up to 24–48 hours to be visible everywhere.

SECTION 08

Post-Launch Checklist

The domain is now live, but a few platform-level details deserve a final pass. Most of them are already wired into the Keja AI build — this checklist confirms that nothing was left pointing at the old subdomain and that search engines and social platforms see the new address consistently.

- ☐ **Canonical URL stays keja.app.** The build defines `SITE_URL = https://keja.app` unless overridden by the `NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL` environment variable. Make sure that variable is **not** set to the old subdomain in Netlify's environment settings — leave it unset to keep the default.
- ☐ **Sitemap and robots.txt.** Both are generated at build time from `SITE_URL` by `scripts/generate-sitemap.mjs`. After the next deploy, open `https://keja.app/sitemap.xml` and `https://keja.app/robots.txt` and confirm every URL starts with `https://keja.app`.
- ☐ **Search engines.** Submit keja.app to Google Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools. Because www redirects to the apex, register the "Domain" property (keja.app) so all variants are covered by one record.
- ☐ **Social sharing preview.** The app ships `og-image.jpg` and Open Graph tags generated from `SITE_URL`. Paste `https://keja.app` into the LinkedIn Post Inspector or Facebook Sharing Debugger once to prime their caches with the new domain.
- ☐ **Service worker and PWA.** The build stamps a new cache version on every deploy via `scripts/sw-version.mjs`. Returning visitors pick up the new domain automatically on their next visit; no migration step is required.
- ☐ **Update external links.** Anywhere the old address was shared — social profiles, email signatures, marketing material, the WhatsApp float number's broadcast templates — replace `keja-ai.netlify.app` with `keja.app`. The old subdomain keeps working via redirect, but the clean URL should be the one people see and share.

SECTION 09

Troubleshooting Common Issues

Almost every domain-linking problem is one of five things: DNS pointing at the wrong place, DNS not propagated yet, a certificate that was never provisioned, a missing redirect, or a stale cache somewhere between the visitor and the site. The table maps each symptom to its most likely cause and the fastest fix. Work top to bottom — the checks in Section 7 tell you which row you are in.

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
keja.app shows "Site not found" or a Netlify 404	DNS resolves, but the domain was not added in Netlify, or another Netlify site holds it	Re-do Section 3; if Netlify says the domain is claimed elsewhere, remove it from the old site/account first
dig shows an IP or CNAME that is not Netlify's	Old records still active, or registrar "parking" defaults	Edit the zone per Section 4: apex A → 75.2.60.5, www CNAME → <code>keja-ai.netlify.app</code> ; delete conflicting records
DNS looks right but the site does not load yet	Propagation lag — old answers are cached	Wait and re-check on whatsmydns.net ; lower TTL values before making changes next time
HTTPS panel stuck on "Waiting on DNS" or cert not issued	Cert provisioning only runs after DNS verifies; occasionally it needs a nudge	Confirm DNS status is green, then click Verify DNS certificate in the HTTPS panel; wait up to an hour and retry
Browser warns the certificate is invalid	Force HTTPS was enabled before the certificate existed, or you are visiting an old cached copy	Disable and re-enable Force HTTPS only after "Cert issued"; hard-refresh or test in a private window
<code>www.keja.app</code> serves content instead of redirecting	<code>keja.app</code> is not set as primary, or <code>www</code> 's certificate is missing	Set <code>keja.app</code> as primary (Section 6) and ensure both certificates are issued
Email on the domain stopped after the switch (Path A)	MX / SPF / DKIM records were not copied into Netlify DNS	Re-create the mail records under Netlify → <code>keja.app</code> → DNS records exactly as they were at the registrar

If everything above checks out and the site still misbehaves, Netlify's support team can inspect the edge-side state of your domain (support.netlify.com, available on all plans for domain issues). Capture the output of `dig keja.app +trace` and the exact URL you tested — it makes their diagnosis dramatically faster.

Your platform, on your own domain.

Once DNS propagates and the certificate is issued, `keja.app` will serve the Keja AI application from the Netlify edge network with full HTTPS. Every future push to `main` deploys straight to production — no further DNS work required.

Keja AI — AI-powered property intelligence for the Kenyan market

Deploy pipeline: GitHub Actions → Netlify API · Canonical build: `keja.app`

Support: Netlify Support (support.netlify.com) · Registrar: your `keja.app` provider